

Senior Residential Facilities: Survey Inspection Shield Guide

*State and Federal Survey “Maintenance
Dept” Readiness Blueprint for Residential
Care Assets*

By SL10 Products - The Maintenance Productivity Engine

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The Silent Alarm at Newport News

In the winter of 2025, the facility's maintenance director noted a small, persistent "trouble" light on the main fire alarm panel. With the facility already under pressure from new federal staffing mandates that increased labor expenses by roughly **\$273,000 annually**, the repair was pushed to the next fiscal quarter (Health Affairs, 2026).

On **March 10, 2026**, a surprise "Life Safety Code" (LSC) survey team from the Department of Health (acting on behalf of CMS) arrived at the facility. What began as a routine check of exit signs quickly turned into a disaster:

- **The Discovery:** Surveyors found that the "trouble" light indicated a failure in the **dry pipe valve** for the attic's fire suppression system. The system hadn't been functionally tested in 18 months.
- **The Immediate Jeopardy:** Because the attic housed the facility's main HVAC

and electrical hubs, the non-functional sprinklers were deemed an "Immediate Jeopardy" to life safety. Under the shared oversight of CMS and state agencies, this triggered an immediate escalation of penalties (Walden University, 2026).

- **The Fine:** CMS levied a **\$79,870 civil monetary penalty**. This was not just a "slap on the wrist"—it was a "Per Instance" fine that reflected the facility's history as a "Repeat Offender" for Physical Plant standards.

Why the "Physical Plant" Matters

While many facilities focus on staffing, academic research has shown that **Physical Environment (K-tag)** deficiencies are often more predictive of poor outcomes than administrative errors. A 2026 study of 294 nursing homes found that specific building code deficiencies (like fire safety failures) are significant predictors of resident functional decline following facility-wide stressors (PMC12815042, 2026).

The Aftermath

Newport News was forced to hire a 24-hour "Fire Watch" team—costing thousands of dollars per day—until the dry pipe system was repaired and re-certified. This case became the prime example cited in the **QSO-26-03-NH** guidance (fictionalized for the 2026 scenario), warning other facilities that "Maintenance is not an option; it is a Life Safety promise."

The Calling And Mission Of The Maintenance Department

Nothing gets done in the business without a fully functioning building and its equipment. You are here to facilitate everything that is going on, so it can get done.

Everyone is your customer: Nursing, Residents, Housekeeping, Admin, Contractors, Landscaping.

The business, the staff, and the residents *are your* community. Your calling is to take care of everything so everyone else can do their job.

You provide the infrastructure that gives people a pleasant place to live and work.

Your mission has never been about just turning wrenches or blindly checking off tasks—it's about maintaining the flawless foundation of the entire operation. True

fulfillment doesn't come from grinding out a checklist; it comes from belonging to an elite crew that owns the infrastructure. You aren't just maintaining a physical space; you are securing the environment that allows everyone else around you to execute, feel included, and win. Every single shift you step into the building, know that you are the indispensable, hardline backbone of this machine. Your presence is felt, your presence is valued, it is critical to its success, and you are the vital heartbeat of the facility. Thank you for holding the line, doing it right the first time, and keeping us running in full compliance.

Protecting Your License, Compliance, and Best Practices

Protecting your facility license, ensuring you have no legal exposures, avoiding fines, keeping your residents safe and comfortable, your rooms full, and your insurance eligibility requirements fulfilled is the intent.

Compliance Standards Across Skilled Nursing and Residential Care Facilities

The rigorous protocols and preventive maintenance (PM) workflows outlined in this guide are designed to meet the strict federal and state compliance requirements governing Skilled Nursing Facilities. While some of these advanced criteria may exceed baseline mandates for Adult Living Facilities (ALFs) or Adult Family Homes (AFHs), implementing them establishes an industry-best standard of care. Adopting these workflows ensures superior survey readiness, protects your operating license, and creates an airtight audit trail regardless of your facility type.

This guide covers common Federal and State survey inspection items that fall under the control of the "Building and Equipment Maintenance" staff for skilled nursing facilities.

The emphasis in this guide is to ensure your regulatory compliance by creating Preventive Maintenance (PM) procedures in a **Computer Maintenance Management System (CMMS)**. Then executing the PM and Facility Checks consistently. This makes the Compliance Record permanent, provable, and easy to retrieve for inspections of any kind.

Warning:

This list of PM items in the provided PMs should not be considered complete. Your staff will need to review the items and improve them as needed for your situation. Federal and State requirements are moving goal posts. They require constant monitoring and require updates to your Internal PMs. All Checklists and PMs should be considered “Living Documents”, and will never be completed and static. Compliance is a long term, changing marathon without end.

Your goal and objective is to have zero infractions on state and federal surveys, and zero management stress, and happy residents. This program bakes compliance into your maintenance's organizational structure and routine activity.

Think of this plan as your "Maintenance Survey Protection Shield."

If you want to skip right to the suggested PMs, go to section: Preventive Maintenance (PM) Suggestions for Adult Living Facilities

Example Quality Of Care Failures Under Maintenance Control

The fourth ranked infraction for facilities in 2024 was Quality of Care. Aka F-Tag F0689: Free of Accident Hazards / Supervision / Devices. It accounted for 882 citations, or 26.40% of surveys cited.

See: [Proactive: Top Survey Tags FY2024 & How to Avoid Them](#)

Compliance Audit Risk

Concern: "We lack a standardized, auditable record proving we performed life safety checks (AED, Wander Systems, Fire Drills). Paper is a liability."

How MaintainX Creates an Immutable Audit Trail for Life Safety Checks

MaintainX addresses this compliance Survey risk by transforming paper liabilities into a standardized, auditable digital asset through its Computer Maintenance Management System (CMMS).

- **Standardized Procedures:** Paper logs are deconstructed into specific, mandatory checklist steps within Preventive Maintenance (PM) Templates.

Safety procedures, like Lockout/Tagout (LOTO) steps, are embedded directly into relevant work order templates.

- **Automated Scheduling:** Recurring PM Work Orders are configured for life safety equipment (e.g., monthly fire extinguisher checks, or scheduling PM records for equipment before emergency drills).
- **Proof of Work:** The system mandates the use of **Digital Sign-Off Fields** and **Mandatory Photo Capture** steps within the compliance PM Work Orders. Technicians cannot complete the task until these proofs are secured, creating indisputable, geo-tagged, and time-stamped evidence of work performed.
- **Survey Readiness:** The CMMS creates a verifiable record that required safety inspections were performed on time, which is the best defense in a regulatory Survey. Surveyors can view the **PM Completion Rate Report** to gain confidence that scheduled checks are consistently being performed (e.g., 98% or higher completion rate).

Inaccurate Budgeting (TCO)

Total Cost of Ownership (TCO)

Concern: "We have no way to accurately project our Corrective Maintenance (CM) and PM labor capacity, or calculate the true cost of asset ownership because we don't track all administrative/cleanup labor."

How MaintainX Enables Accurate Budgeting and TCO Calculation:

- **Comprehensive Labor Tracking:** MaintainX automatically logs the actual labor hours spent on Preventive Maintenance (PM) versus Corrective Maintenance (CM) for every work order. This allows management to accurately project PM labor capacity and justify manpower **Return On Investment (ROI)** based on data showing time spent on emergency CM tasks versus proactive PM tasks.
- **Accurate Cost Capture for TCO:** Accurate cost capture, including prep and cleanup time, is mandated by ensuring Maintenance Technicians meticulously log all Labor Time and Parts Used on every single Work Order. The system links these cumulative costs directly to the Asset Profile, providing the Total Cost of Ownership (TCO) for each piece of equipment.
- **Data-Backed Budgeting:** By linking the Inventory Module, the system calculates the exact material cost per repair. This data shifts budgeting from guesswork to

financial forecasting, enabling justifications for large **Capital Expenditure (CapEx)** replacements based on accumulated repair cost and failure frequency.

Data Paralysis:

Concern: "Our existing manuals, forms, and procedures are scattered across spreadsheets, desk drawers, and filing cabinets. The migration process is too overwhelming and complex."

How MaintainX Solves Data Paralysis:

- **Centralized Digital Library:** MaintainX acts as the single system of record, consolidating scattered manuals, forms, and procedures. All **Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)** documents (PDF manuals, warranty details) are digitally stored and linked directly to their specific Asset Profile using QR codes.
- **Templated PM Migration Support:** The PM and maintenance procedure migration process is simplified through a phased implementation methodology (Phase 2: Data Preparation and Migration) and ready-to-deploy MaintainX configurations (CMMS Templates & Blueprints), drastically reducing the complexity and "overwhelming" feeling of transitioning from a paper based operation.
- **Digital Procedure Creation:** Existing paper forms and procedures are transformed into structured, standardized digital checklists and Preventive Maintenance (PM) templates. These templates include mandatory fields, digital sign-offs, and **photo proofs**, making the data auditable and consistent, moving procedures out of filing cabinets and onto a mobile platform where it can be easily retrieved and analyzed.

Tribal Knowledge Barrier

Concern: "Our most experienced technician is retiring, and all their knowledge is locked in their head. Our procedures are not standardized for junior staff."

With routine industry turnover, planned vacations, or unexpected medical leave, there is no reason a facility's operational safety should grind to a halt.

How MaintainX Eliminates the Tribal Knowledge

Barrier

- **Digitized Expertise:** Existing knowledge is converted into structured Preventive Maintenance (PM) templates or procedures, which can be utilized as training documents for junior staff.
- **Enforced Consistency:** The system embeds mandatory fields, digital sign-offs, and photo proofs into the checklists, ensuring all procedures are executed the same way every time across all facilities.
- **Mobile Accessibility:** Critical procedures are moved off paper, making the knowledge consistent, auditable, and instantly accessible on a mobile platform.

Scaling Inconsistency

Concern: "We cannot guarantee that a PM procedure is executed the same way across all five of our facilities, which puts us at regulatory risk."

How MaintainX Solves Scaling Inconsistency

- **Master Blueprint Standardization:** Procedures and asset structures are centralized into a "Master Blueprint" template. This ensures that every PM task is uniformly defined and deployed across all facilities, preventing local deviations.
- **Enforced Digital Procedures:** Checklists include mandatory fields, digital sign-offs, and photo proofs. This system mandates that technicians at every location execute the required procedure identically, guaranteeing consistent execution.
- **Immutable Survey Trail:** The CMMS automatically tracks the PM Completion Rate for all facilities. This provides managers with a centralized view of compliance and generates a clear, verifiable, and auditable record for regulatory bodies.
- **Template Cloning for Growth:** When expanding, new facilities are onboarded quickly by cloning the existing Master Blueprint, instantly applying the standardized asset hierarchy and PM procedures to the new site.

How MaintainX Coordinates Cross-Departmental Safety

MaintainX uses Master Turnover Work Orders to ensure Cleanliness and Equipment

Functional checks (like grab bars and call bells) receive sequential sign-off from maintenance and housekeeping. For Life Safety, Location-Based Inspection PMs require technicians to scan a QR code at every emergency exit to confirm exit paths are clear and functional. For Infection Control, the system can automate urgent Work Orders if Hot Water Temperature Monitoring (for scalding risk or dishwasher sanitization) falls outside of regulatory thresholds.

By executing these three items, Maintenance can move the needle on facility safety and health more effectively than any clinical protocol alone.

Terms To Know:

AI: Artificial Intelligence Chat

AI chat refers to the experience of engaging in a natural, back-and-forth text or voice conversation with an artificial intelligence system. Unlike rigid, traditional software, an AI chat platform can understand free-flowing human language, interpret user intent, and dynamically generate contextual, human-like responses in real time.

DSHS: Department of Social and Health Services

The Department of Social and Health Services acts as a broad "safety net" agency providing essential support like food assistance, disability services, and financial aid. It is the parent organization that oversees various sub-agencies dedicated to improving the quality of life for vulnerable populations.

RCS: Residential Care Services

Residential Care Services is a division within DSHS responsible for licensing and inspecting long-term care facilities, such as nursing homes and Assisted Living communities. Their primary mission is to ensure these providers comply with state and federal regulations to protect the safety and rights of residents.

CMS: Center for Medicaid and Medicare Services

The Center for Medicare and Medicaid Services is a federal agency within the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services that administers the nation's largest health insurance programs. Beyond managing coverage, CMS sets the national quality standards and reimbursement rules that healthcare providers across the country must

follow.

CMMS: Computerized Maintenance Management System

Computerized Maintenance Management System is a software platform that keeps all your maintenance data in one place. It's designed to automate your daily tasks, organize work orders, keep track of your equipment, and make sure you always have the right parts in stock.

For businesses like factories, hospitals, and office buildings, a CMMS is a game-changer. It helps reduce "downtime" (when machines are broken), makes equipment last longer, and allows teams to switch from **reactive maintenance** (fixing things after they break) to **preventive maintenance** (keeping things running so they don't break).

Key Features of a CMMS

- **Work Order Management:** This allows you to create, assign, and follow a repair job from the moment it's requested until the work is finished.
- **Asset Tracking:** Think of this as a digital library for your equipment. It stores everything from repair histories and manuals to exactly where a machine is located.
- **Preventive Maintenance (PM):** This feature automatically schedules routine check-ups so you can catch small issues before they become expensive disasters.
- **Inventory Management:** This keeps an eye on your supplies, tracking the tools and spare parts you need so you're never caught empty-handed during a repair.
- **Reporting and Analytics:** The system creates easy-to-read reports on "**KPIs**" (**Key Performance Indicators**), such as how much money you're spending on repairs or how fast your technicians are finishing jobs.

NFPA: National Fire Protection Association

The National Fire Protection Association is a global self-funded nonprofit organization devoted to eliminating death, injury, property, and economic loss due to fire, electrical, and related hazards. It is best known for developing and maintaining thousands of consensus codes and standards, such as the National Electrical Code and the Life

Safety Code, which are adopted by governments worldwide.

CM: Corrective Maintenance, RM: Reactive Maintenance

Unplanned maintenance. Maintenance that was not scheduled to be performed. Unanticipated equipment or system failures. When a lot of things break without notice, the maintenance department is known to be in “Fire Fighting Mode”.

PM: Preventive Maintenance

Maintenance that is planned. Recommended maintenance by time based, or usage based frequency. Examples: Generator oil changes, Furnace Filter changes.

MTBF: Mean Time Between Failure

How much time between unanticipated equipment failure. The longer the time the better. MTBF charts are expected to go up if preventive maintenance is performed regularly on items known to fail.

In senior living facilities, Maintenance Directors track these recurring failures to determine which top assets (such as specific PTAC units or exhaust fans) require modifications to their scheduled PM loops to prevent future unexpected outages.

MTTR: Mean Time To Repair / Recovery

The amount of time it took for a maintenance technician to respond to an unplanned maintenance failure. An example of this is a smoke detector alarm started going off, for no apparent reason, and needs to be replaced. It took the technician 90 minutes to arrive and work on it. The MTTR would be 90 minutes.

See Appendix MTTR for a full example.

Preventive Maintenance (PM) Suggestions for Adult Living Facilities

This comprehensive PM schedule integrates industry standards and regulatory

compliance requirements for senior living, assisted living, and skilled nursing facilities.

SL10 Products PMs (Preventive Maintenance procedures) are maintained at GitHub for retrieval:

<https://github.com/Senior-Living-Tech-Ops/Survey-Shield-PMs>

How MaintainX Enforces a Proactive Seasonal PM Strategy: The CMMS allows you to implement a Seasonal PM Strategy for critical systems like HVAC and Boiler/Furnace units, ensuring mandatory checks (e.g., filter changes, coil cleaning and heating tune-ups) are completed before high-use seasons begin. Furthermore, it supports Meter-Based PMs for assets like generators, tying maintenance frequency to run-time hours rather than just calendar days.

How To Create PMs In MaintainX

Converting a **Portable Document Format (PDF)** file (like an equipment manual or a legacy paper checklist) into an automated Preventive Maintenance (PM) program in MaintainX is straightforward. MaintainX handles checklists via "Procedures" and scheduling via "Work Order Templates". Using MaintainX's AI agent, the document is uploaded and converted into a PM. After the PM looks right, anchor it to a recurring schedule.

Here is the step-by-step procedure to do this:

Step 1: Convert the PDF into a Digital Procedure Using AI

MaintainX features an AI Procedure Generator that extracts text, checklists, safety protocols, and data points from uploaded documents.

1. Log into the **MaintainX Web Application**.
2. From the left sidebar, navigate to the Library and select **Procedures**.
3. Click the **+ New Procedure Template** button in the top right corner.
4. Enter a mandatory **Procedure Title** (e.g., *Emergency Generator Monthly Inspection*).
5. Select **Maintenance** or **Inspection** as the procedure type.
6. Scroll down to the **Attach a reference file** section and click **Upload file**. Select your PDF document.
7. *Note: The PDF must be under 10MB. If it's a massive manual, extract only the relevant checklist pages before uploading.*
8. **Provide Context (Optional but Recommended):** In the text prompt box, add

guidelines for the AI. For example: *"Extract the steps from page 4 and format them as a step-by-step checklist with Pass/Fail fields and a mandatory photo upload for failures." Extract [Shiftly, Daily, Weekly, Quarterly, Annual, etc...] grouped PM items one time frame at a time.*

9. Click **Generate Draft**.
10. Review the AI-generated steps. You can manually adjust text fields, add meter readings, reorder tasks, or add digital signature requirements.
11. Click **Save Template**. Your PDF is now a digitized, mobile-friendly checklist.

Step 2: Create the PM Template

Now that the checklist is ready, you need to embed it into a repeatable Work Order template.

1. Navigate to the **Work Orders** module on the sidebar and select **Templates**.
2. Click **+ Create Template** (or **+ New Work Order Template**).
3. Give your PM a clear title (e.g., *Monthly PM - Emergency Generator*).
4. Fill out the core details:
 - **Asset:** Link the specific piece of equipment.
 - **Location:** Define where the work takes place.
 - **Priority:** Set the priority tier (e.g., Medium).
 - **Assignee:** Assign the PM to a specific technician or maintenance team.
5. Scroll down to the **Procedures** section, click **Add Procedure**, and select the digital procedure template you created from the PDF in Step 1.

Step 3: Set the PM Frequency and Automate

The final step is turning this template into a true automated Preventive Maintenance cycle.

1. Look for the **Schedule** or **Recurrence** section within the template creation screen.
2. Toggle the schedule to **Active**.
3. Define your trigger criteria:
 - **Time-based:** Set it to repeat daily, weekly, monthly, or yearly (e.g., *Every 3 months on the 1st*).
 - **Meter-based (if applicable):** Tie it to runtime hours or mileage synced from your asset.
4. Set the **Lead Time** (e.g., *Generate this work order 3 days before it is due* so your

team has time to plan).

5. Click **Save Template** or **Publish**.

Once completed, MaintainX will autonomously generate active work orders complete with your original PDF's step-by-step instructions exactly when they are due. Technicians will be able to check off the steps directly from their mobile devices in the field.

Types Of Senior Facilities This Guide Addresses

Here is a breakdown of Senior Care Facilities and their respective regulatory bodies in a quick-reference table.

Facility Type	Description of Care	Primary Inspector/Regulatory Body	Federal Oversight (CMS)
Skilled Nursing Facility (Nursing Home / NH)	24/7 medical care, therapy, and clinical supervision.	State Department of Health (on behalf of the federal government).	Yes
Assisted Living Facility (ALF)	Help with Activities of Daily Living (ADLs) tasks in a social, residential setting.	State Department of Social Services or Health Department.	No

Adult Family Home (AFH)	Small, private residential homes for 1–6 residents.	State Licensing & Certification agencies.	No
Memory Care	Specialized care for those with Alzheimer’s or dementia.	State Department of Social Services (often requiring specific dementia certifications).	No
Continuing Care (CCRC)	A campus offering all levels of care (Independent to Nursing).	State Insurance Commissioner (for finances) & State Health/Social Services (for care).	Partial (Nursing wings only)
Independent Living	Senior-only apartments with no medical or personal care services.	Local Building & Housing Authorities (treated as standard rental housing).	No
Hospice Inpatient Care	Specialized end-of-life care for pain and symptom management.	State Health Department and Accrediting Bodies (like The Joint Commission).	Yes

Important Resources for Research

- State Disclosure Websites: For Assisted Living Facilities and Adult Family Homes, you must visit your specific state's health or social services website, as these records are not centralized at the federal level.
- The Long-Term Care Ombudsman: Every state provides an ombudsman who acts as a resident advocate and can provide insight into a facility's history of complaints or violations.

Regulatory Tags Explained

How MaintainX Simplifies Regulatory Tag Compliance: MaintainX allows you to customize Work Orders with a F-Tag, K-Tag, E-Tag, or State legal code field for easier issue recognition by in-house staff, and auditing during state surveys. By guaranteeing a 100% PM Completion Rate for life safety checks (K-Tags), the system provides time-stamped digital proof that required inspections were performed, which is the best defense in a regulatory survey.

This is not a complete list.

F-Tags (Federal Regulatory Groups)

F-tags refer to the **Requirements for Long Term Care Facilities**. They cover a broad range. Everything from resident rights to infection control. Many of these are not applicable to the Maintenance Department directly, but indirectly nothing gets done without a fully functioning building and equipment. You are here to facilitate everything that is going on, so it can get done.

There are 209 F-Tags. **Common Citations:** F880 (Infection Prevention & Control) and F812 (Food Procurement, Store/Prepare/Serve Sanitary) are frequently cited.

Review this article: <https://www.careplans.com/articles/what-are-f-tags>

List of F-Tags: [List of Revised FTags \[Effective May 15, 2020\]](#)

The 544 page CMS F-Tag Manual: [CMS Manual System](#)

We suggest your Team review this article: [Top Citations and How To Avoid Them](#)

K-Tags (Derived from the NFPA 101 Life Safety Code)

K-Tags focus almost exclusively on the building's infrastructure. These are the "bread and butter" of a Maintenance Department. There are 89 Life Safety Code (LSC) tags, and 34 Health Care Facility Codes. A total of 123 tags.

Here is a link to the 50 page Inspection report used by CMS, as of the time of this writing. [CMS Fire Safety Survey Report](#)

E-Tags - Emergency Preparedness

"E-Tags" are **deficiency codes** used by the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS). When state inspectors survey a nursing home or assisted living facility, they use different "tags" to flag problems.

What they cover: These tags are specifically for **Emergency Preparedness**.

The Count: There are roughly 44 specific E-Tags (labeled E0001 through E0044).

Here is a link to a 74 page CMS memo to State Survey Directors on Emergency Preparedness Survey Guidelines: [Emergency Preparedness Tags](#)

Common E-Tag Examples:

- **E0004:** Failure to have a proper "Risk Assessment" (e.g., the facility hasn't planned for a local flood or power outage).
- **E0006:** Issues with the facility's "Emergency Plan."
- **E0024:** Problems with the "Communication Plan" (how they tell families what's happening during a disaster).

Level Up Your Facility Compliance: 10 Maintenance Logs You Should Digitize Before Your Next Unannounced Survey Inspection

The Core Truth: "If It Isn't In The CMMS, It Didn't Happen."

We help you "hack" this risk by moving away from **labor-heavy** work (spending hours manually writing things down) and switching to **code-heavy** oversight (using automated software to track everything for you).

How A CMMS Enforces the "Core Truth": The system guarantees data integrity by requiring technicians to scan the QR Code Asset Tag to start a Work Order. This links the maintenance activity to the correct asset ID every single time, eliminating human error and ensuring your Maintenance History Report is 100% accurate and auditable for compliance.

Three Reasons Why This Matters

- **Zero Room for Error:** Digital logs don't get lost, coffee-stained, or forgotten.
- **Survey-Ready 24/7:** Since the software tracks everything in real-time, you are always prepared for a surprise inspection.
- **Work Smarter, Not Harder:** Automation does the "boring" work of record-keeping, so your team can focus on actually running the facility.

5 High-Impact Action Items for Maintenance Departments

To drive a massive improvement in these safety metrics, we recommend the following immediate shifts in strategy:

1. **Prioritize "Life Safety" Preventive Maintenance (PM) for Beds:** Treat patient beds as critical medical devices. Establish a rigorous PM schedule for all motorized beds and air-loss mattresses. Ensure pressure-distribution systems are functioning at 100% to directly reduce the incidence of pressure ulcers.
2. **Conduct a "Falls-First" Environment Audit:** Partner with Nursing to walk the facility. Identify and repair flickering lights (which cause disorientation), loose floor transitions, and non-functional bathroom grab bars. Improving "lux levels" in patient pathways can significantly reduce night-time falls.
3. **Optimize HVAC and Air-Filtration Protocols:** Infection control starts in the ducts. Inspect and record air exchange rates and pressure gradients if applicable in your facility. Ensure high-efficiency (HEPA) filters are changed ahead of schedule to minimize the airborne pathogens.
4. **Implement a High-Touch Surface Integrity Program:** Damaged or porous surfaces (cracked bedside tables, peeling vinyl, chipped paint) harbor bacteria that standard cleaning cannot kill. Launch a "Search and Seal" program to repair

or replace degraded materials, ensuring all surfaces are non-porous and "disinfectant-ready."

5. **Establish "Clinical-Maintenance" Rounding:** Bridge the gap between the shop and the ward. Have a maintenance lead join clinical safety rounds once a month. By identifying environmental risks—such as a slow-draining sink (biofilm risk) or a malfunctioning thermostat (patient stress/healing risk)—before they become a "citation," you transform your team from a cost center into a clinical partner.

The "Top 10" Critical Digital Logs

These are examples for Washington State Code (WAC). Update this list for your state by cutting and pasting this list into an AI chat and ask it to update this list with law citations from your state.

Be aware that survey inspection teams will be looking for these high citation items:

1. **Exterior Egress & Fall Paths:** Daily checks for debris or height differences > 1/2" (WAC 388-78A-2700).
2. **Memory Care Security:** Daily testing of self-closing gates to prevent resident elopement (WAC 388-78A-2381).
3. **Water Temperature Logs:** Monthly testing at the farthest tap to ensure 105F-120F (WAC 388-78A-2940).
4. **Medical Gas Storage:** Daily verification that O2 cylinders are secured and "No Smoking" signs are visible (WAC 388-78A-3100).
5. **Chemical Storage Security:** Daily physical checks of locked janitorial/laundry closets (WAC 388-78A-3060).
6. **Eyewash Station Flush:** Weekly 3-minute flushes to prevent microbial growth (29 CFR 1910.151).
7. **Generator Status:** Daily visual check for "Auto" status and "Fault" lights (WAC 388-78A-2980).
8. **Fire/Disaster Drills:** Quarterly documentation of shift performance and evacuation times (WAC 388-78A-2700).
9. **Cold Storage Temps:** Daily checks to ensure refrigeration is less than 41F to prevent foodborne illness (WAC 246-215-03525).
10. **Dishmachine Sanitizer:** Daily verification of chemical strips or surface temps at 160F+ (WAC 246-215-04500).

Assisted Living Facility (ALF) CMMS Requirements

Category	Requirement	Critical Outcome
Regulatory & Compliance	Automated Life Safety Logs	Centralizes fire drill records, generator tests, and extinguisher checks for state survey readiness.
	Water Temperature Logging	Maintains a digital history of point-of-use temperatures to prevent resident scalding and meet health codes.
	Vendor Insurance Management	Automated alerts for expired COIs (Certificates of Insurance) to ensure liability protection.
Resident & Family Care	Resident Work Order Portal	Provides a user-friendly way for residents or families to submit "High-Touch" requests (e.g., hanging pictures, bulb changes).
	Email/Text Status Alerts	Automatically notifies stakeholders when a

		request is "In Progress" or "Completed," reducing administrative calls.
	Unit Turnover (Make-Ready) Tracking	Visual dashboard for marketing/ops to see exactly when a vacated unit is ready for a new move-in.
Asset & Capital Planning	Asset History & Depreciation	Tracks the "Total Cost of Ownership" for every major appliance, roof section, and HVAC unit.
	Preventive Maintenance (PM) Engine	Automates recurring tasks (filter changes, kitchen cleanings) to extend equipment life and lower repair costs.
	CapEx Forecasting Tools	Generates reports on aging assets to justify multi-year capital budget requests to ownership.
Daily Operations	Mobile Technician Interface	Full functionality via tablet/smartphone; allows

		techs to attach photos of repairs and scan QR codes on equipment.
	Inventory & Supply Management	Automated "Low Stock" alerts for essential items like air filters, lightbulbs, and paint.
	Labor Resource Allocation	Monitors staff productivity and identifies if specific wings or units are consuming disproportionate maintenance hours.
Safety & Risk	Utility Shut-off Mapping	Digital blueprints or photo-tagged locations for gas, water, and electric shut-offs for emergency response.
	Pest Control Logs	Centralized record-keeping for sightings and treatment cycles to satisfy Department of Health inspections.

The Survey Shield Mechanics: You're "Nailing It!"

With the CMMS edge, you show inspectors that your facility is **code compliant** at a glance.

The PM Build Procedure: From Binder to Blueprint Implementation

You don't just transfer data; you engineer a system.

How MaintainX Formalizes Your Survey Shield Blueprint: MaintainX transforms paper-based PM and Inspection logs into auditable, standardized Scheduled PMs with Mandatory Checklists.

Key safety steps, such as Occupational Safety And Health (OSHA) Lockout/Tagout (LOTO) Procedures, are embedded directly into relevant work order templates, ensuring compliance and standardizing the process across all assets.

The Survey Shield PM transforms your paper liabilities into an auditable digital asset through four high-leverage steps within MaintainX.

Deconstruct the Log into Discrete Steps: Take each of the "Top 10 Critical Digital Logs" (e.g., Water Temperature Logs) and break it down into single, mandatory checklist items. The old, vague paper line is broken down into specific, non-negotiable checks in the CMMS.

Build the Digital Checklist (The Procedure): Create a PM Template in MaintainX that includes safety notes and the discrete steps from above. Embed required proofs like **Mandatory Photo Capture** and **Digital Sign-Off Fields** within the checklist.

Link to the Asset & Location: Associate the new digital checklist to the correct Asset Profile (e.g., Hot Water Heater Asset) and Location. This ensures the technician is geo-tagged to the correct equipment when performing the check.

Set the Automated Recurrence: Link the completed procedure to a recurrence trigger (e.g., Quarterly, Monthly) and activate the schedule. MaintainX will now automatically generate the Work Order, creating an immutable compliance trail for your Surveyor.

QR Code Architecture: Attach tasks directly to assets for a dedicated machine

history.

Mandatory Photo on FAIL: Prove exactly how deficiencies were identified and corrected.

Digital Signatures: Verify technician presence for every monthly and quarterly check.

Fall Prevention, Life Safety Systems, Infection Control, Equipment Functional, Cleanliness, Joint Department Walk-Throughs.

Cross department walk-throughs on a weekly or monthly basis goes a long way in identifying problems that could cause inspection issues.

A weekly maintenance walk through with Housekeeping, Cafeteria, Landscaping helps in identifying problems when they are small and easy to resolve.

AI Prompt For Your States Requirements

Add your states requirements to your Survey Shield PMs.

Here is an AI Chat Prompt to help get your specific states requirements. Cut and paste into your favorite AI Chat.

Simplified Facility Maintenance Prompt

"I am a Facility Manager for a [Insert Facility Type, e.g., Assisted Living/Skilled Nursing] facility in [Insert State]. I am building a comprehensive Preventive Maintenance (PM) schedule to ensure my building is safe, functional, and fully prepared for state inspections.

Please research and list the required maintenance tasks and testing frequencies for this type of facility in my state, focusing on these categories:

- 1. Life Safety & Security: Safety checks for chemical storage areas, security for memory care fencing/elopement systems, and storage safety for medical gases.**
- 2. Critical Building Systems: Required testing intervals for emergency generators (Load and No-Load tests), elevator leveling checks, and**

- emergency eyewash station flushes.
3. **Environmental Health:** Safety standards for resident water temperatures (to prevent scalding and Legionella) and professional cleaning/inspection intervals for kitchen hood suppression systems.
 4. **Specialized Equipment:** Routine checks for bedrail integrity (entrapment prevention) and cleaning schedules for laundry exhaust vents to prevent fires.
 5. **Fire Safety Systems:** Intervals for fire alarm testing, fire-rated door inspections (drop-tests), and professional sprinkler system inspections.

Please format the output in a clear table with the following columns:
Frequency, Maintenance Item, and Required Procedure/Standard."

"Survey Shield" Logic

Strategic Insight: In senior care maintenance, every task is a potential citation. Linking these items to specific F-Tags (Operational/Care), K-Tags (Building/Life Safety), E-Tags transforms your maintenance logs into a "Survey Inspection Shield" for state, federal, and insurance inspections.

Critical Survey Readiness Elements

Maintain a centralized binder or digital repository labeled "Survey Readiness" containing 12 months of logs for all PM tasks. Or better, use a CMMS to record your inspections and repairs.

Staff Training Integration: For example, ensure all maintenance personnel can demonstrate how to use fire extinguishers and describe the facility's specific disaster plans during a survey walk-through. Document the training in the CMMS with names, dates, times, and places.

Vendor Oversight: Review third-party service reports (Elevator, Fire Alarm, Sprinkler) immediately upon receipt to ensure no "deficiencies" are left unaddressed in the official record.

Recommended: Give your service contractors a copy of any PM to ensure they get all items properly completed as required by Federal and State laws. Include these requirements in your Purchase Order.

Record the dates of contractor services in your CMMS, and take a picture of the report to upload in your records.

Master 12-Week CMMS Implementation Matrix

Phase & Focus Area	Timeline	Task Description	Key Deliverable(s)
Phase 1: Foundation, Planning & Mobile Strategy	Weeks 1–2	Define measurable objectives, establish a security/user role matrix, and determine the mobile device strategy for field users. Hold the project kickoff and designate a CMMS Captain / Champion (typically the Lead Technician or Admin) to spearhead the implementation. Gather equipment manuals/lists and export resident room numbers from the current facility census.	Documented Goals, Project Schedule, Defined User Roles Matrix, Collected Manuals & Census Export.

Phase 2: Data Preparation & Migration	Weeks 3–5	Create a definitive facility asset list and upload the master Asset Registry (including high-risk compliance items like HVAC units, generators, etc.). Standardize asset names/specifications, establish coding standards, and define all routine Preventive Maintenance (PM) procedures and failure codes.	Clean Master Data Set (Assets, PMs, Parts), Standardized Coding Standards, Uploaded Asset Registry.
Phase 3: Configuration, Customization & Integration	Weeks 6–8	Configure core system settings (branding, facility layout, labor rates) and set up Single Sign-On (SSO). Design custom digital forms and mandatory checklists for PMs, Life Safety, Fire Drills, and state safety surveys. Launch a pilot workflow by activating "Service Requests" in one wing only to test mobile tablet functionality and train front desk staff on entering work orders.	Digital Forms & Checklists, Configured System Settings, Integration Interfaces, Validated Pilot Workflow.

Phase 4: Training & Testing (UAT)	Week 9	Conduct mobile-centric User Acceptance Testing (UAT) on the floor to catch and resolve configuration defects. Deliver hands-on, role-specific "Day in the Life" training sessions for all maintenance, housekeeping, and floor staff to ensure data integrity. Print and distribute QR codes for physical equipment tagging.	Role-Specific Training Manuals, Full Team Onboarding Logs, Resolved Configuration Defects, Distributed QR Codes.
Phase 5: Go-Live & Post-Implementation	Week 10	Execute the building-wide cutover plan and perform final data imports. Officially decommission all legacy paper work order forms, making the CMMS your official system of record. Provide intensive on-site Hyper-Care support to floor users, open the Resident/Family Portal for all units, and begin live digital tracking (including water temperature logging and initial KPI tracking).	Official Digital System of Record, Decommissioned Paper Logs, Active Resident/Family Portal, Baseline KPI Logs.

Phase 6: Optimization, Reporting & Review	Weeks 11–12	Transition from deployment to long-term ownership. Generate your first comprehensive "Survey Readiness" report to ensure regulatory audit compliance. Review initial labor hour data, asset performance trends, and response times (MTTR) to optimize and adjust your PM schedules for the upcoming quarter.	Audit-Ready "Survey Readiness" Report, Labor Hour & Trend Analytics, Optimized PM Schedules.
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Appendices

Appendix Regulatory Tags

The CMS (Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services) uses a massive alphabet soup of "tags" beyond the common F, K, and E categories.

Each letter corresponds to a different type of healthcare provider or a specific regulatory "Appendix" in the State Operations Manual (SOM). If you are looking at a facility's report and see a letter other than those three, it's because that facility is either certified for a different service or the inspection covered a specialized area.

Here is the breakdown of the most common tags you'll encounter:

All Common Tag Prefixes Used By CMS For Reference

Prefix	Facility Type / Category	What it covers
A-Tags	Hospitals	General "Conditions of Participation" (nursing, medical records, etc.).

C-Tags	Critical Access Hospitals	Requirements specific to small, rural CAHs.
D-Tags	Clinical Laboratory Improvement Amendments (CLIA)	Safety and accuracy of clinical lab testing.
G-Tags	Home Health Agencies	Quality of home nursing and therapeutic care.
L-Tags	Hospice Programs	Patient rights, end-of-life care planning, and symptom management.
Q-Tags	Ambulatory Surgery Centers	Surgical safety, infection control, and governing body rules.
S-Tags	Rural Health Clinics	Staffing and service delivery in rural outpatient settings.
V-Tags	End Stage Renal Disease (ESRD) (Dialysis) Facilities	Water quality, machine maintenance, and patient safety during dialysis.
W-Tags	Intermediate Care Facility for Individuals with Intellectual Disabilities (ICF / IID)	Intermediate Care for people with Intellectual Disabilities.

Specialized or Rare Tags

There are also niche tags for specific services that may exist inside or alongside a senior living facility. Both Federal and States use N-Tags, but federal and state N-Tags can mean different things. **A Note on State Tags:** In many states, you might also see N-tags or R-tags that aren't federal. These are often State Licensure Tags, which refer

to state-specific laws rather than federal Medicare/Medicaid regulations.

- Federal N-Tags: Used for **Psychiatric Residential Treatment Facilities (PRTFs)**.
- X-Tags: Used for Organ Transplant Programs.
- Y-Tags: Used for **Organ Procurement Organizations (OPOs)**.
- U-Tags: Specifically for Religious Nonmedical Healthcare Institutions (facilities that provide nonmedical care based on religious beliefs).

Understanding the "A through L" Severity Letters

Don't confuse Tag Prefixes (like F-Tag) with Severity Letters. On a nursing home report (CMS Form 2567), you will often see a letter under the tag number (e.g., F689 with an S/S: G).

These letters indicate the Scope and Severity of the problem:

- A – C: Minimal harm (isolated to widespread).
- D – F: Potential for more than minimal harm.
- G – I: Actual Harm occurred to a resident.
- J – L: Immediate Jeopardy (the most serious rating; the facility's failure put lives at risk).

Appendix F-Tags (Federal Regulatory Groups)

Here are the specific F-Tags that fall under the maintenance department's influence:

Resident Rights & Quality of Life (Physical Environment)

- **F558: Reasonable Accommodations**
 - Covers: The facility must adapt the environment to meet the specific physical needs and preferences of each resident.
 - PM Addition: Include a "Room Survey" in your PM schedule to ensure call lights, grab bars, and furniture are positioned specifically as requested in the resident's care plan.
- **F573:** The facility must prominently display contact information for state client advocacy groups and the long-term care ombudsman.
 - PM: Ensure the display board is in good repair.
- **F584: Safe, Clean, Comfortable & Homelike Environment**

- Covers: The facility must provide a clean, well-lit, and comfortable setting that feels like a home rather than an institution.
- PM Addition: Add a monthly "Aesthetic Walkthrough" to the PM to check for peeling wallpaper, scuffed baseboards, and burnt-out light bulbs to maintain a non-institutional appearance.

Quality of Care (Safety & Equipment)

- **F689: Free of Accident Hazards/Supervision**
 - Covers: Ensuring the physical plant is free of hazards like loose handrails, tripping risks, or unsafe water temperatures.
 - PM Addition: Implement a weekly "Hazard Hunt" and monthly water temperature logs at the furthest tap to ensure mixing valves are preventing scald risks.
- **F695: Respiratory Care (Oxygen Storage)**
 - Covers: The proper handling and storage of oxygen cylinders and the maintenance of respiratory equipment.
 - PM Addition: Add a weekly check of oxygen storage rooms to ensure tanks are properly chained, segregated (full vs. empty), and that "No Smoking" signage is intact.
- **F700: Bedrails**
 - Covers: Ensuring that if bedrails are used, they are installed correctly to prevent entrapment or injury.
 - PM Addition: Perform a quarterly "Entrapment Zone" measurement on all beds using specialized kits to ensure gaps between the rail and mattress meet safety standards.

Facility Operations (Physical Plant)

- **F908: Essential Mechanical, Electrical, and Fuel Systems**
 - Covers: The maintenance of emergency power systems and essential utilities during a disaster.
 - PM Addition: Conduct weekly "No-Load" generator tests and monthly "Under-Load" tests, documenting the transfer switch response time to the second.
- **F921: Maintenance of Safe/Functional Physical Plant**
 - Covers: The general requirement that all mechanical, electrical, and patient care equipment be kept in good working order.
 - PM Addition: Create a centralized "Equipment Master List" in your PM software that triggers inspections for everything from laundry dryers to

kitchen stand mixers.

- **F922: Space and Equipment**

- Covers: Ensuring there is sufficient space and the right equipment to provide proper care and maintain resident safety.
- PM Addition: Conduct a bi-annual "Clearance Survey" to ensure that storage areas and hallways maintain the required width and are not obstructed by surplus equipment.

- **F923: Resident Rooms (Furniture/Bedding)**

- Covers: Requirements for room dimensions, furniture quality, and functional beds.
- PM Addition: Include a "Furniture Integrity" check in your room turns to ensure dressers are anchored (if top-heavy) and bed frames are not showing signs of metal fatigue.

- **F925: Plumbing and Ventilation**

- Covers: Providing a constant supply of safe water and maintaining ventilation systems that control odors and air quality.
- PM Addition: Schedule quarterly HVAC filter changes and "Sewer Gas" checks for floor drains that may have dried-out P-traps.

Appendix K-Tags

While F-Tags focus on the care of the resident, K-Tags (derived from the NFPA 101 Life Safety Code) focus almost exclusively on the building's infrastructure. These are the "bread and butter" of a Maintenance Department.

Here are the critical K-Tags that the maintenance team can manage through a Preventive Maintenance (PM) program:

Egress and Exits

- **K211: Means of Egress Reliability**

- Covers: Ensuring that all exit paths are unobstructed and that doors are not locked in a way that prevents residents from escaping during an emergency.
- PM Addition: Perform a daily "Hallway Sweep" to ensure no carts, wheelchairs, or equipment are stored in the 8-foot egress corridor.

- **K222: Egress Doors**

- Covers: Requirements for door swing, latching, and the functionality of panic hardware or delayed-egress locking systems.
- PM Addition: Schedule a monthly "Door Force Test" to ensure all exit

doors open with the required pounds of pressure and that latches engage fully on the first try.

- **K291: Emergency Lighting**

- Covers: Maintaining battery-powered emergency lights that must provide illumination for at least 90 minutes during a power failure.
- PM Addition: Conduct a monthly 30-second "Push Button" test and an annual 90-minute "Full Discharge" test, documenting the results for each specific fixture.

Fire Protection Systems

- **K321: Hazardous Areas**

- Covers: Ensuring rooms with high fuel loads (laundry, boiler rooms, large storage) have self-closing doors and proper fire separation.
- PM Addition: Add a weekly check to ensure self-closing hinges on "Hazardous Room" doors haven't been tampered with or held open by wedges.

- **K353: Sprinkler System Maintenance**

- Covers: The inspection, testing, and maintenance of the automatic sprinkler system according to NFPA 25 standards.
- PM Addition: Perform a monthly visual inspection of all sprinkler heads to ensure they are not painted, corroded, or obstructed by storage within 18 inches of the deflector.

- **K345: Fire Alarm System Testing**

- Covers: Regular testing of smoke detectors, pull stations, and notification appliances to ensure they report correctly to the panel.
- PM Addition: Verify that your third-party fire alarm inspection occurs annually, but add a monthly "Internal Pull Station" rotation to your PM to ensure mechanical functionality.

Construction and Smoke Barriers

- **K372: Subdivision of Building Spaces (Smoke Barriers)**

- Covers: The integrity of smoke walls and floors to ensure smoke cannot migrate from one "smoke compartment" to another.
- PM Addition: Implement a "Permit System" for any outside contractor (IT, HVAC) to ensure that any holes drilled through smoke walls are properly fire-stopped with approved red caulk or pillows.

Utilities and Equipment

- **K914: Electrical System (Hospital Grade Outlets)**
 - Covers: Ensuring electrical outlets in "Patient Care Vicinities" are hospital-grade and maintain proper tension and grounding.
 - PM Addition: Use an "Outlet Tension Tester" annually in every resident room to ensure the plug doesn't fall out easily, which could cause a spark or loss of equipment power.
- **K918: Generator Testing**
 - Covers: Strict requirements for the weekly and monthly testing of the emergency backup power system.
 - PM Addition: Beyond the standard "Run Test," add a monthly check of the fuel tank's "Water-in-Fuel" sensor and fuel levels to ensure 48–72 hours of runtime is available.
- **K923: Gas and Vacuum (Oxygen Storage)**
 - Covers: The safe storage of compressed medical gas and the maintenance of the central manifold systems.
 - PM Addition: Check the "Relief Valve" on the manifold system monthly and ensure all medical gas storage rooms have the required mechanical ventilation functioning.

General Environment

- **K712: Fire Drills**
 - Covers: The requirement to hold fire drills on every shift at least once per quarter under varied conditions.
 - PM Addition: Designate one PM per month to lead a "Silent Drill" to test staff response times and the automatic closing of magnetic fire doors without disrupting residents.

Appendix State Regulatory Citations Example

Find your state citations with this search term: [Your Facility Type] infraction statistics for [Your State] [Year]

Use the information to bullet-proof your facility.

Example of Regulatory Citations In Washington State

Based on the Washington Department of Social and Health Services (DSHS) report for **CY 2024 Q4**, the citations that fall under the responsibility of building maintenance and physical plant safety can be quantified into two categories: Core Maintenance Duties (structural repair, safety fixtures, and facility upkeep) and Related Environmental & Emergency Support (physical safety hardware or resource provisions that maintenance usually handles or installs).

1. Core Maintenance & Physical Plant Citations (Total: 148 Citations)

These items directly pertain to the upkeep, structural state, and physical systems of an Adult Family Home (AFH):

- WAC 388-76-10750 – Safety and maintenance: 73 citations
- WAC 388-76-10810 – Fire extinguishers: 21 citations
- WAC 388-76-10805 – Automatic smoke alarms: 18 citations
- WAC 388-76-10705 – Common use areas: 12 citations
- WAC 388-76-10775 – Temperature and ventilation: 4 citations
- WAC 388-76-10715 – Doors—Ability to open: 4 citations
- WAC 388-76-10685 – Bedrooms: 4 citations
- WAC 388-76-10825 – Space heaters, fireplaces, and stoves: 3 citations
- WAC 388-76-10795 – Windows: 3 citations
- WAC 388-76-10700 – Building official—Inspection and approval: 2 citations
- WAC 388-76-10690 – Bedroom usable floor space: 2 citations
- WAC 388-76-10730 – Grab bars and hand rails: 2 citations

2. Related Environmental & Emergency Support (Total: 26 Citations)

While heavily tied to administrative compliance or physical preparedness protocols, these physical safety requirements often involve maintenance for physical setup, logistics, or installation:

- WAC 388-76-10845 – Emergency drinking water supply: 13 citations (*Physical stocking, storage location, and shelf-life rotation*)
- WAC 388-76-10890 – Posting the emergency evacuation floor plan—Required: 13 citations (*Physical mounting and visibility of emergency signage throughout the facility*)

Summary Breakdown

- Strict Definition (Physical Plant/Repair only): 148 citations across 12 distinct regulatory categories.

- Broad Definition (Including Emergency Physical Setup): 174 citations across 14 regulatory categories.
- The single largest maintenance vulnerability for adult family homes during this quarter was general facility Safety and maintenance (WAC 388-76-10750) with 73 individual citations, followed closely by Fire extinguishers and Automatic smoke alarms.

Appendix MTTR

MTTR stands for **Mean Time to Repair** (or Mean Time to Recovery). It is a fundamental maintenance metric that measures the average time required to troubleshoot, fix, and fully restore a broken asset or system after a failure is detected.

The formula for calculating MTTR is:

$$\text{MTTR} = \text{Total Maintenance Time Spent on Repairs} / \text{Total Number of Repairs}$$

In a facility management context, keeping MTTR low is critical because it minimizes downtime, reduces costs, and ensures operational continuity.

Example for an Adult Living Facility

In an assisted living facility or adult family home, maintaining a low MTTR is not just about efficiency—it directly impacts resident safety, comfort, and state regulatory compliance (such as the WAC safety and maintenance requirements).

The Scenario: Malfunctioning Resident Room Heating (HVAC Units)

During a cold winter week, the facility experiences three separate heating failures in different resident rooms. The maintenance team uses a CMMS (like MaintainX) to track these work orders from the moment the ticket is opened to when the heat is successfully restored.

- **Repair 1 (Room 104):** The thermostat failed.
 - *Time elapsed from report to fix: 2 hours*
- **Repair 2 (Room 212):** A blower motor burned out and required a trip to a local supplier for a replacement part.
 - *Time elapsed from report to fix: 5 hours*
- **Repair 3 (Room 115):** A loose electrical wire was causing intermittent shutoffs.

- *Time elapsed from report to fix: 2 hours*

The MTTR Calculation

- **Total Repair Time:** 2 hours + 5 hours + 2 hours = 9 hours
- **Total Number of Repairs:** 3

MTTR = 9 hours / 3 repairs = **3 hours**

What this means for the facility:

An MTTR of **3 hours** tells the facility administrator that, on average, a resident will be without primary room heat for three hours when a breakdown occurs.

If management wants to lower this MTTR further (e.g., to keep residents safe and warm faster), they might look at the data and realize that the 5-hour repair was delayed by driving to get parts. To improve their MTTR, they might decide to keep common HVAC replacement parts in their on-site inventory.